demand of the Taliban that Pakistan should stop cooperating with America.

Saleem Safi's later columns showed that the TTP message had due effect on him and advised the media to give appropriate coverage to the TTP point of view, which according to him was ignored by the Pakistani media.

In 2008–2009, Muslim Khan was the active spokesperson of Maulvi Fazlullah, the then chief of the TTP Swat chapter. He was arrested during an army operation and was incarcerated. Later, Sirajuddin Ahmad appeared as the spokesperson of the Swat Taliban, who had been expelled from Swat and made the TTP base in Afghanistan's Kunar and Nuristan provinces. He claimed the responsibility of attack on the Swat girl Malala, known for her courageous stance against the Swat Taliban, who had shut down her school. He said that 'We had no intentions to kill her but were forced when she would not stop (speaking against us)' (Jibran, 2012).

On the Malala issue, Ehsanullah Ehsan also wrote a seven-page email to columnist and anchor Hamid Mir to threaten him and to put forward their views about Malala. Hamid Mir wrote in his column that he had been interacting with militants and terrorists throughout his 25-year career. He had even interviewed Osama bin Laden. However, it was his first time to come across someone who would use such a filthy and derogatory language as was used by Ehsanullah Ehsan against Malala in his letter addressed to him. Ehsanullah had termed her a US spy and a woman of easy virtue who was worth slaying. Hamid Mir termed these allegations as horrible. He added that once during a meeting with Osama bin Laden, his companion Abu Hifz Almisri used some harsh words about the then US Secretary of State, Madeline Albright. Osama interrupted him, apologised to Hamid and said that he did not like objectionable utterances about women (Mir, 2012). Probably, Hamid Mir narrated this incident to highlight the fact that the TTP, unlike its mentor, believed in a no-holds-barred approach.

The TTP spokesperson did not always operate from a remote unidentified place located deep inside the tribal area nor was he very cautious about disclosure of his identity. He gave an interview to CNN in Peshawar. He was in contact with a few officials of government agencies in Islamabad (Mir, 2012). Ehsanullah Ehsan appeared in a video with Hakimullah Mehsud and Waliur Rehman, which showed